



Journal of Statistical Software: What is it? Who reads it? Why submit to it?

Rebecca Killick(r.killick@lancs.ac.uk)
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- Why have a journal of statistical software?
- What do we publish?
- Who reads JStatSoft?
- What are we looking for in submissions?

<https://www.jstatsoft.org/>

- Statistical software production has boomed in recent years
- Users want to know what is “good” statistical software
- We are NOT software developers . . .
- . . . but coding literacy is increasing
- Standards set expectations and keep the community honest



- Papers about novel implementations of statistical algorithms within software
- We review the software and the paper equally
- We expect authors to discuss the following aspects of their software:
 - design
 - implementation
 - documentation
 - application
- We do not restrict software languages other than a requirement for open-source GPL-compatible licensing.

What do we publish?

- Code snippets
 - like regular articles but about smaller software packages
- Book reviews
 - of books related to statistical software

What do we NOT publish?

- New statistical methodology or algorithms that have not been published elsewhere
- Software without a corresponding article
- Papers which are not fully reproducible
- Software which does not add substantial value to the community
- Articles where we cannot find a suitable AE or reviewers



- Those looking to use your software
 - Practitioners
 - Researchers
 - Teachers
 - Students

Often these people may not have a background in statistics or be in statistically focused roles!

What are we looking for?

- Editors-in-chief pre-screen all papers and software
- We use a set of standards around usability and convention
- Guidance to authors is:
 - Readable and have comments
 - Where possible, formatted help files and packaged code
 - Where possible, available from standard repositories
 - Where sensible, leverage classes and methods
 - We link to rOpenSci standards, but not mandatory
- After pre-screening the submission is sent to reviewers who also have software packages



- We implemented a new editorial system with greatly improved workflows in September 2021
 - OJS: Open Journal Systems
- Let's show you how it works . . .